

BRAND IDENTITY DESIGN

FULL VISUAL STUDY MANUAL

Brand Identity System

A brand is more than a logo

Purpose

Why the organisation exists

Position

How it should be understood

Voice

How it communicates

Visuals

How it is recognised

Experience

How people encounter it

Consistency

How trust is reinforced

Course Code	EDA-BID-120
Level	Beginner to Intermediate
Duration	6 Weeks (19 Lessons)
Certificate	Professional Certificate in Brand Identity Design
Prerequisite	Graphic Design Fundamentals recommended
Learning Format	Brand Strategy + Guided Design Practicals + Final Identity System Project

Responsible brand-design standard: create original identity work; do not copy or closely imitate protected logos or commercial artwork; use authorised assets and accurate claims; perform appropriate trademark/domain checks before real commercial adoption.

Course Introduction

Brand Identity Design teaches learners how to turn brand strategy into a coherent visual and verbal system. The course moves from discovery and positioning through logo systems, colour, typography, imagery, voice, guidelines, applications, sub-brand consistency, audits and professional handoff.

Learning Objectives

- Conduct structured brand discovery and audience research.
- Develop positioning, personality and core messaging.
- Create an original flexible logo system.
- Build functional colour and typography systems.
- Define supporting graphics and image direction.
- Create brand voice and layout rules.
- Produce useful brand guidelines.
- Apply identity across digital and print touchpoints.
- Complete and hand off an organised mini brand identity system.

Course Structure

1. Lesson 1: Introduction to Brand Identity Design
2. Lesson 2: Brand Discovery and Research
3. Lesson 3: Brand Strategy and Positioning
4. Lesson 4: Naming, Taglines and Brand Architecture
5. Lesson 5: Logo Design Principles
6. Lesson 6: Building a Logo System
7. Lesson 7: Brand Colour Systems
8. Lesson 8: Brand Typography
9. Lesson 9: Supporting Graphic Elements
10. Lesson 10: Photography and Image Direction
11. Lesson 11: Brand Voice and Messaging
12. Lesson 12: Layout Systems and Brand Consistency
13. Lesson 13: Brand Guidelines
14. Lesson 14: Digital Brand Applications
15. Lesson 15: Print and Business Applications
16. Lesson 16: Brand Consistency Across Sub-Brands
17. Lesson 17: Brand Audits and Refreshes
18. Lesson 18: Brand Asset Management and Handoff
19. Lesson 19: Final Brand Identity Project

Lesson 1: Introduction to Brand Identity Design

Introduction

Brand identity is the planned system of visual and verbal elements that helps people recognise, understand and remember an organisation. A logo is important, but it is only one part of the identity.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of introduction to brand identity design.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for introduction to brand identity design.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Brand identity includes logo, colour, typography, imagery, layout style and supporting graphic elements.

Brand principle: Brand strategy explains the meaning and direction behind the visible identity.

Brand principle: Consistency strengthens recognition, but consistency does not mean every design must look identical.

Brand principle: A useful identity must work in real contexts and at different sizes.

Brand principle: Originality and responsible use of intellectual property are essential.

Brand Identity System

A brand is more than a logo

Purpose

Why the organisation exists

Position

How it should be understood

Voice

How it communicates

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Figure 1: Original instructional visual for Introduction to Brand Identity Design.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Choose a fictional training brand or use Ethan Digital Academy as a study case.
2. List its purpose, audience and three desired qualities.
3. Identify five places where the identity would appear.
4. Write one sentence explaining what the identity should communicate.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy needs an identity system that can work across courses, social media, certificates, apps, presentations and printed materials.

Review Questions

20. What is the main purpose of introduction to brand identity design?
21. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
22. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
23. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 1 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 2: Brand Discovery and Research

Introduction

Identity design begins with discovery: understanding the organisation, audience, context and communication problem before drawing a logo.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand discovery and research.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand discovery and research.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Discovery gathers facts about the organisation and its goals.

Brand principle: Audience research considers needs, expectations and communication habits.

Brand principle: Competitor review helps avoid visual imitation and reveals category conventions.

Brand principle: Brand values should be specific enough to guide decisions.

Brand principle: Research should inform design without copying competitors.

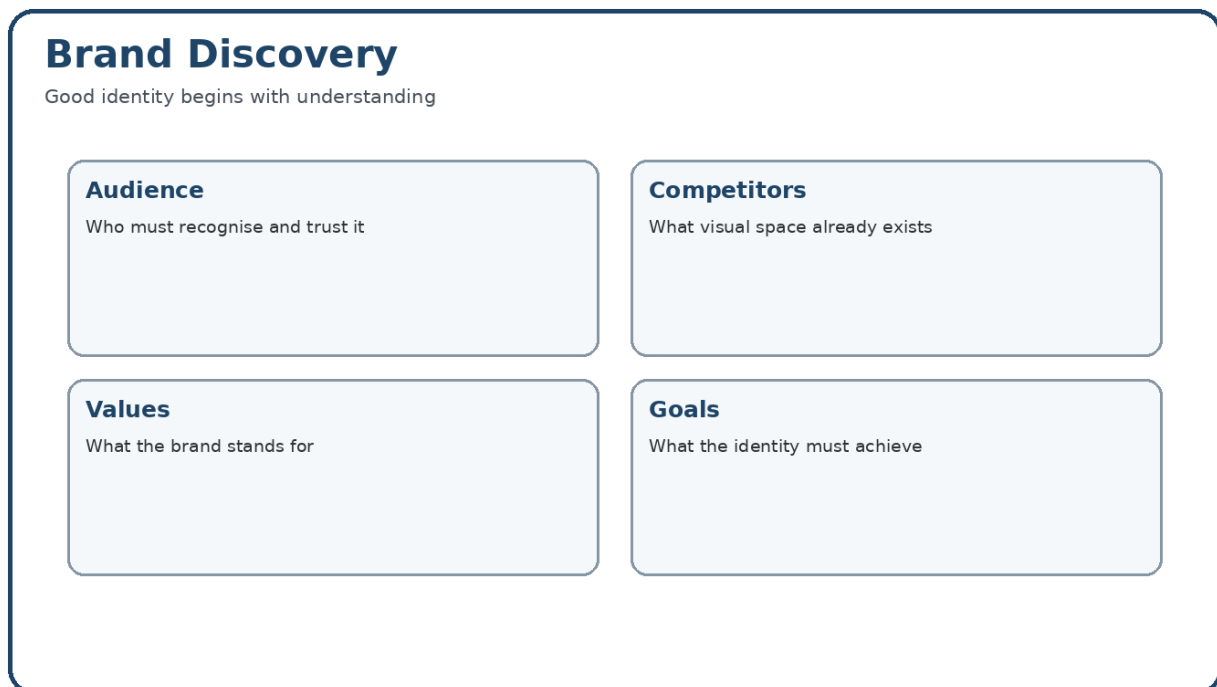


Figure 2: Original instructional visual for Brand Discovery and Research.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a discovery questionnaire with ten questions.
2. Answer it for a fictional education brand.
3. List three audience needs.
4. Review three category competitors only for patterns, not for copying.
5. Write a short discovery summary.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Before redesigning an Academy identity, the designer should understand its learners, programmes, digital products and professional positioning.

Review Questions

24. What is the main purpose of brand discovery and research?
25. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
26. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
27. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 2 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 3: Brand Strategy and Positioning

Introduction

Brand strategy turns discovery into a clear direction for how the organisation should be perceived.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand strategy and positioning.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand strategy and positioning.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Positioning defines a distinct and relevant place in the audience's mind.

Brand principle: A brand promise describes the value the organisation aims to deliver.

Brand principle: Personality uses human qualities to guide expression.

Brand principle: A core message summarises the most important idea.

Brand principle: Strategy gives designers criteria for choosing between visual options.



Figure 3: Original instructional visual for Brand Strategy and Positioning.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Write a one-sentence positioning statement.
2. Define three personality traits.
3. Write one brand promise.
4. Write a short core message.
5. Check whether the five statements agree with each other.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy may position itself around practical, modern and accessible digital learning rather than around decorative technology imagery alone.

Review Questions

28. What is the main purpose of brand strategy and positioning?
29. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
30. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
31. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 3 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 4: Naming, Taglines and Brand Architecture

Introduction

Names and taglines help audiences understand and remember brands, while brand architecture explains relationships between a main brand and its products or sub-brands.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of naming, taglines and brand architecture.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for naming, taglines and brand architecture.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: A name should be distinctive, pronounceable and suitable for its context.

Brand principle: A tagline should add meaning rather than repeat the name.

Brand principle: Brand architecture can use a master brand, endorsed brands or more independent sub-brands.

Brand principle: Naming decisions should consider domain, trademark and cultural checks before commercial adoption.

Brand principle: A visual relationship between sub-brands should be deliberate.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create three fictional brand names for a training service.
2. Write one tagline for each.
3. Choose the strongest and explain why.
4. Draw a simple map showing a master brand and three services.
5. Label which elements should stay visually related.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can maintain a clear relationship between the Academy and products such as Ethan Learn while still allowing each product to have a useful role.

Review Questions

32. What is the main purpose of naming, taglines and brand architecture?

33. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
34. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
35. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 4 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 5: Logo Design Principles

Introduction

A logo is a recognisable identifier. Strong logos are usually distinctive, appropriate, reproducible and flexible.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of logo design principles.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for logo design principles.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Begin with concept and meaning before effects.

Brand principle: Simple geometry can improve reproduction and recognition.

Brand principle: A logo should work at small sizes and in one colour.

Brand principle: Wordmarks, symbols and combination marks serve different needs.

Brand principle: Do not trace, imitate or closely reproduce protected logos.

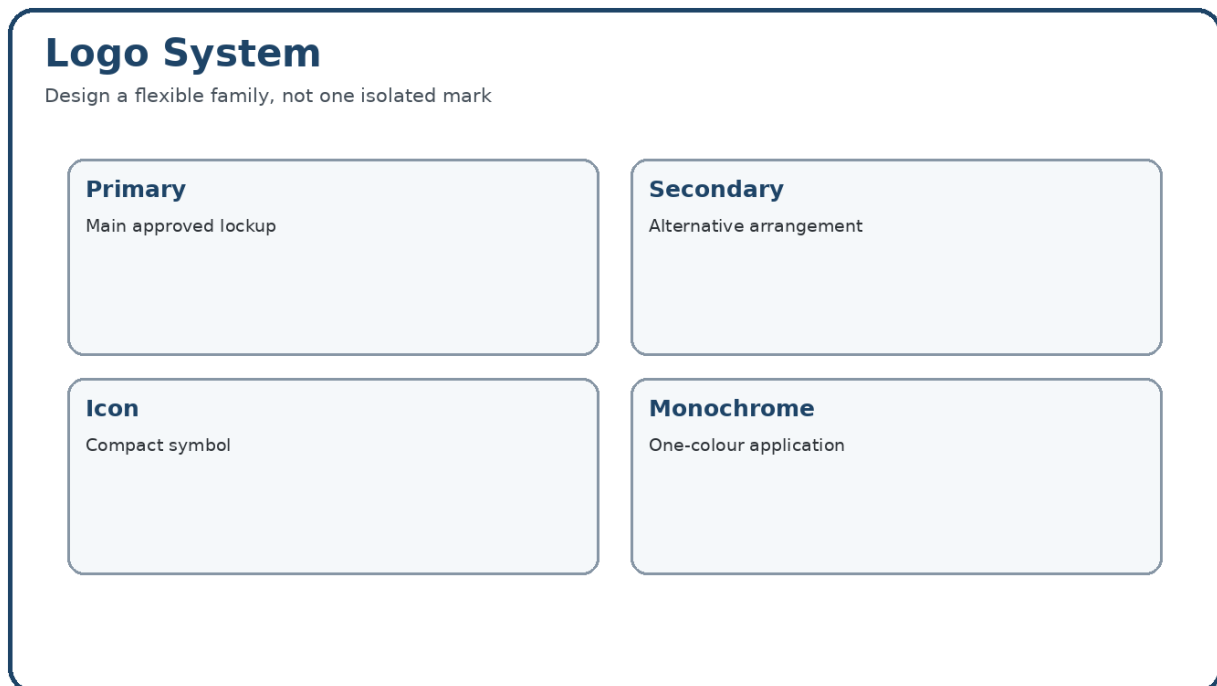


Figure 5: Original instructional visual for Logo Design Principles.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Write three concepts based on the brand strategy.
2. Sketch at least six rough original ideas.
3. Choose two for refinement.
4. Test both in black and white.
5. Select one based on strategy rather than personal decoration preference.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy logo should remain clear on a website header, certificate, social profile and small mobile screen.

Review Questions

36. What is the main purpose of logo design principles?
37. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
38. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
39. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 5 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 6: Building a Logo System

Introduction

Professional identities often require several approved logo configurations for different spaces.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of building a logo system.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for building a logo system.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: A primary logo is the preferred full version.

Brand principle: A secondary lockup can fit different proportions.

Brand principle: An icon or symbol may serve compact spaces.

Brand principle: Monochrome versions support restricted colour situations.

Brand principle: Clear-space and minimum-size rules protect legibility.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a primary logo for a fictional brand.
2. Create one alternate arrangement.
3. Create a compact icon if the concept supports it.
4. Create one-colour versions.
5. Define a simple clear-space rule.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can use a full Academy lockup on documents and a compact approved mark in smaller app interfaces.

Review Questions

40. What is the main purpose of building a logo system?
41. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
42. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
43. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 6 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 7: Brand Colour Systems

Introduction

Brand colours create recognition and emotional tone when their roles are clearly defined.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand colour systems.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand colour systems.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Primary colours carry the strongest identity role.

Brand principle: Secondary colours extend the system.

Brand principle: Accent colours highlight selective information.

Brand principle: Neutral colours support text, backgrounds and interface needs.

Brand principle: Contrast and accessibility must be checked in real applications.

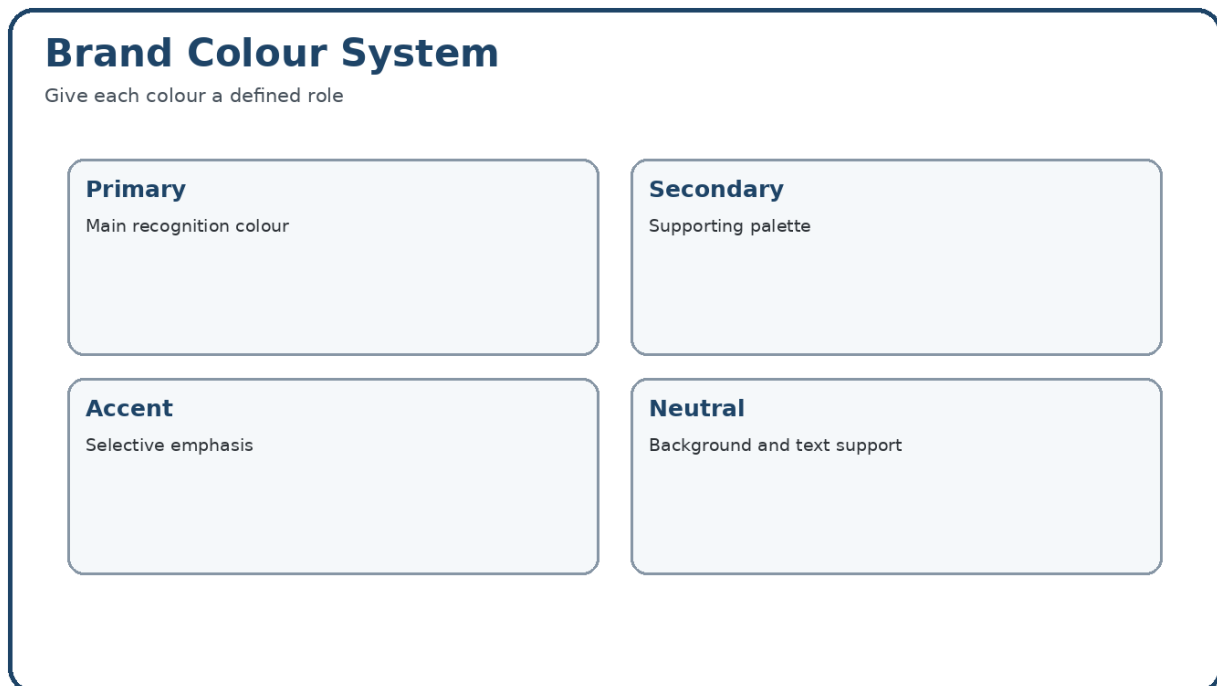


Figure 7: Original instructional visual for Brand Colour Systems.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Choose a primary colour and two supporting colours.
2. Add useful light/dark neutrals.
3. Assign a role to each colour.
4. Create a light and dark sample application.
5. Check whether important text remains readable.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy colour system should work not only on promotional graphics but also on course interfaces and documents.

Review Questions

44. What is the main purpose of brand colour systems?
45. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
46. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
47. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 7 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 8: Brand Typography

Introduction

Typography gives written communication a consistent visual voice.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand typography.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand typography.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Typography roles can include display, heading, body and utility text.

Brand principle: A small type system is easier to maintain than many unrelated fonts.

Brand principle: Readability is more important than novelty.

Brand principle: Font licensing and availability affect real deployment.

Brand principle: Spacing and hierarchy should be documented.

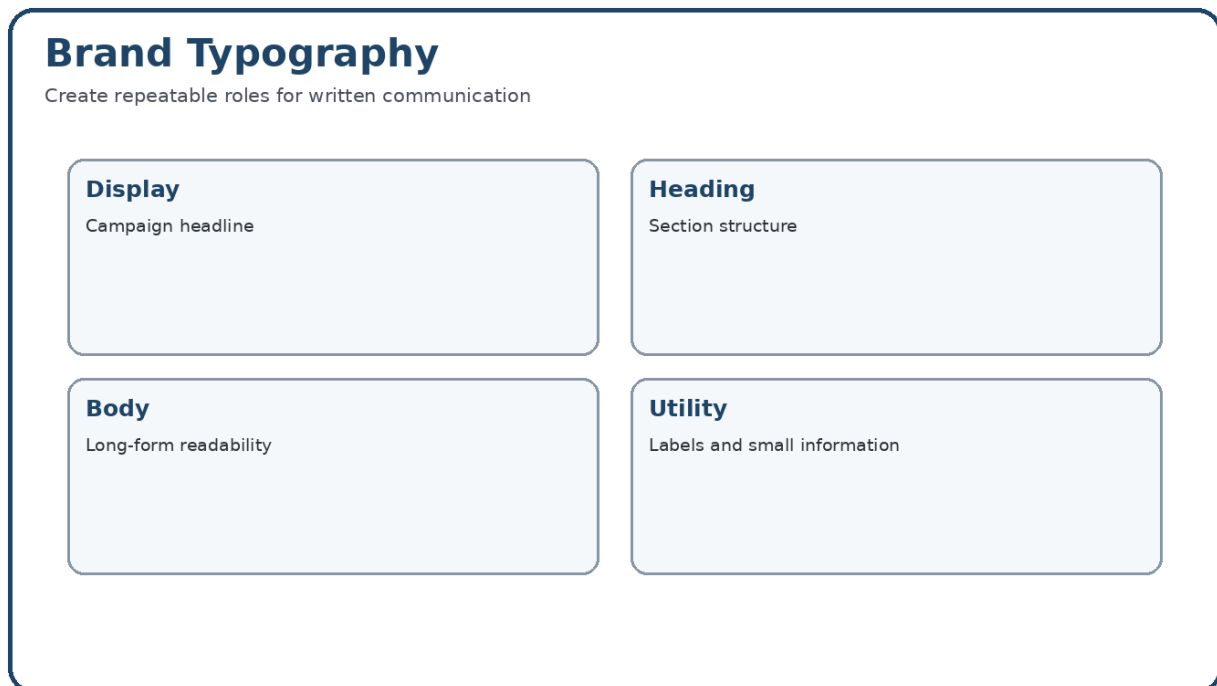


Figure 8: Original instructional visual for Brand Typography.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Choose authorised fonts for a fictional identity.
2. Define display, heading and body roles.
3. Create a sample headline and paragraph.
4. Test a small information label.
5. Record size/weight relationships rather than only font names.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan materials can feel related when the same typography hierarchy appears across social graphics, presentations and manuals.

Review Questions

48. What is the main purpose of brand typography?
49. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
50. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
51. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 8 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 9: Supporting Graphic Elements

Introduction

Patterns, shapes, lines, icons and other devices can extend an identity beyond the logo.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of supporting graphic elements.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for supporting graphic elements.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Supporting elements should come from the brand idea or visual system.

Brand principle: Repeated motifs can strengthen recognition.

Brand principle: Icons should use a consistent style.

Brand principle: Patterns should not compete with important content.

Brand principle: Graphic devices should still work when the logo is not dominant.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Derive one simple shape or motif from the logo concept.
2. Create a small pattern.
3. Design three original icons in one style.
4. Apply the motif to a social graphic.
5. Remove any element that feels decorative but unrelated.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy identity can use a consistent line, frame or geometric motif across course categories without placing a large logo everywhere.

Review Questions

52. What is the main purpose of supporting graphic elements?
53. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
54. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
55. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 9 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 10: Photography and Image Direction

Introduction

Image direction defines what kinds of photographs or illustrations fit the brand and how they should be treated.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of photography and image direction.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for photography and image direction.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Subject matter should support the brand's real audience and activities.

Brand principle: Crop and composition can create consistency.

Brand principle: Lighting and colour treatment should remain believable.

Brand principle: Images must be original, authorised or properly licensed.

Brand principle: Do not use images to imply partnerships, results or events that did not occur.

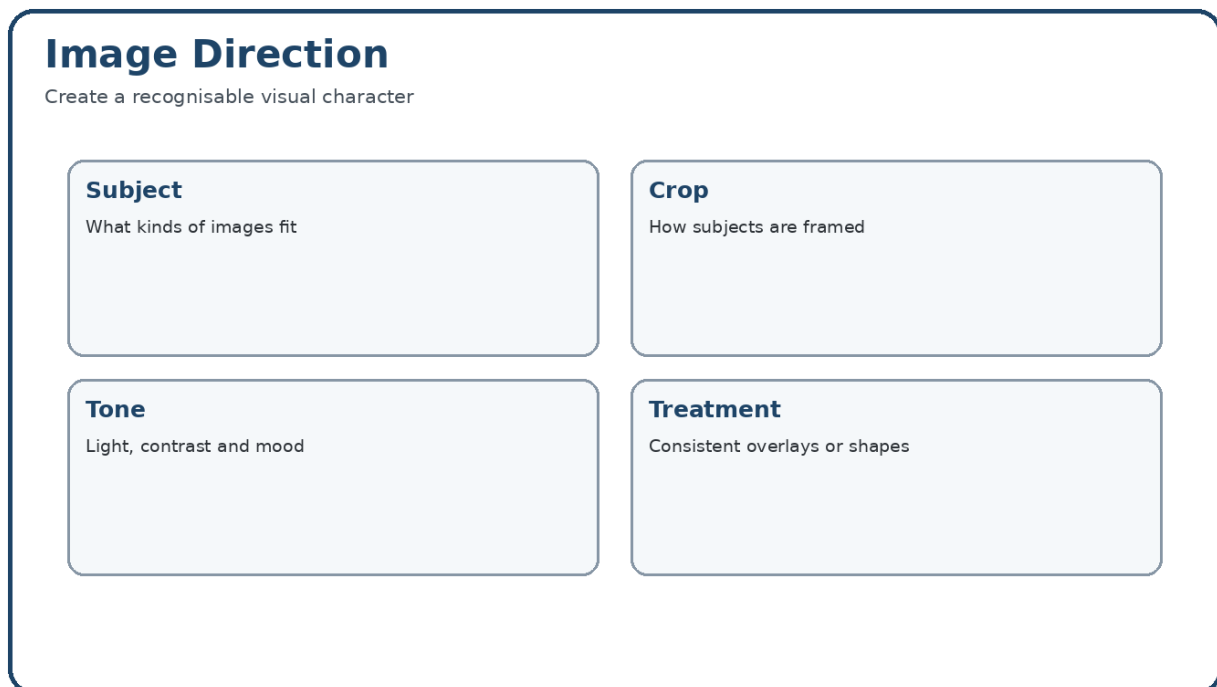


Figure 10: Original instructional visual for Photography and Image Direction.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Collect five authorised practice images.
2. Group them by what fits or does not fit the brand.
3. Define a crop rule.
4. Define a simple tone/treatment rule.
5. Create a one-page image-direction board.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can prioritise authentic learning, technology and professional-development imagery rather than unrelated stock clichés.

Review Questions

56. What is the main purpose of photography and image direction?
57. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
58. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
59. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 10 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 11: Brand Voice and Messaging

Introduction

A brand is also recognised by how it speaks. Voice should support the same personality expressed visually.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand voice and messaging.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand voice and messaging.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Voice is the consistent communication character.

Brand principle: Tone can change slightly by situation while voice remains recognisable.

Brand principle: Vocabulary should suit the audience.

Brand principle: Clear language is usually stronger than unnecessary jargon.

Brand principle: Claims should be accurate and supportable.

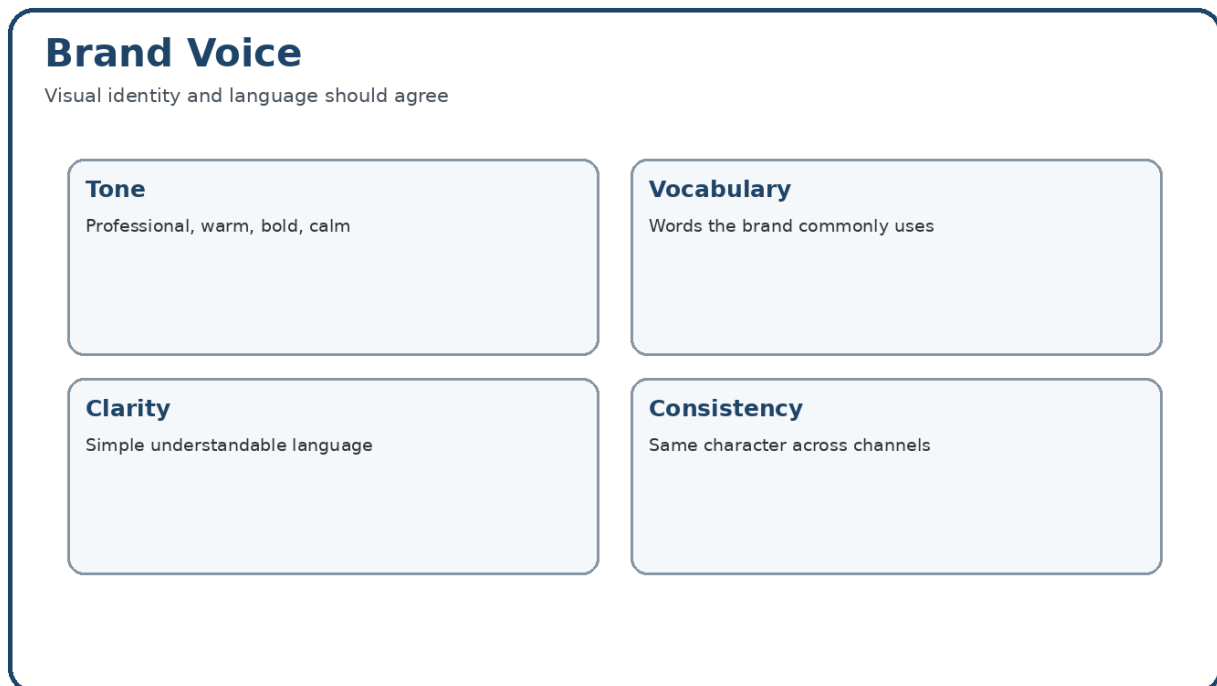


Figure 11: Original instructional visual for Brand Voice and Messaging.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Define three voice traits.
2. Write a 40-word course announcement.
3. Rewrite it for a formal certificate notice.
4. Rewrite it for a social post while preserving the same brand character.
5. Remove unsupported or exaggerated claims.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can sound professional and encouraging across learner messages without using developer language in student-facing content.

Review Questions

60. What is the main purpose of brand voice and messaging?
61. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
62. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
63. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 11 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 12: Layout Systems and Brand Consistency

Introduction

Layout rules connect typography, colour, imagery and graphic elements into repeatable compositions.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of layout systems and brand consistency.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for layout systems and brand consistency.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Grids create predictable structure.

Brand principle: Margins and spacing create visual rhythm.

Brand principle: Repeated content blocks improve consistency.

Brand principle: Hierarchy should remain clear across different formats.

Brand principle: A brand system should allow controlled variation.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a simple grid for a square post.
2. Create a matching grid for an A4 flyer.
3. Use the same typography and colour roles.
4. Adapt one message to both layouts.
5. Compare recognition across the two formats.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy campaigns can look related even when a poster and a mobile social graphic use different compositions.

Review Questions

64. What is the main purpose of layout systems and brand consistency?
65. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
66. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
67. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 12 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 13: Brand Guidelines

Introduction

Brand guidelines document how to apply the identity consistently and correctly.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand guidelines.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand guidelines.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Guidelines should explain rather than merely display assets.

Brand principle: Logo pages can show versions, spacing and misuse examples.

Brand principle: Colour pages should provide defined values.

Brand principle: Typography pages should show roles and hierarchy.

Brand principle: Application examples help users understand the system.

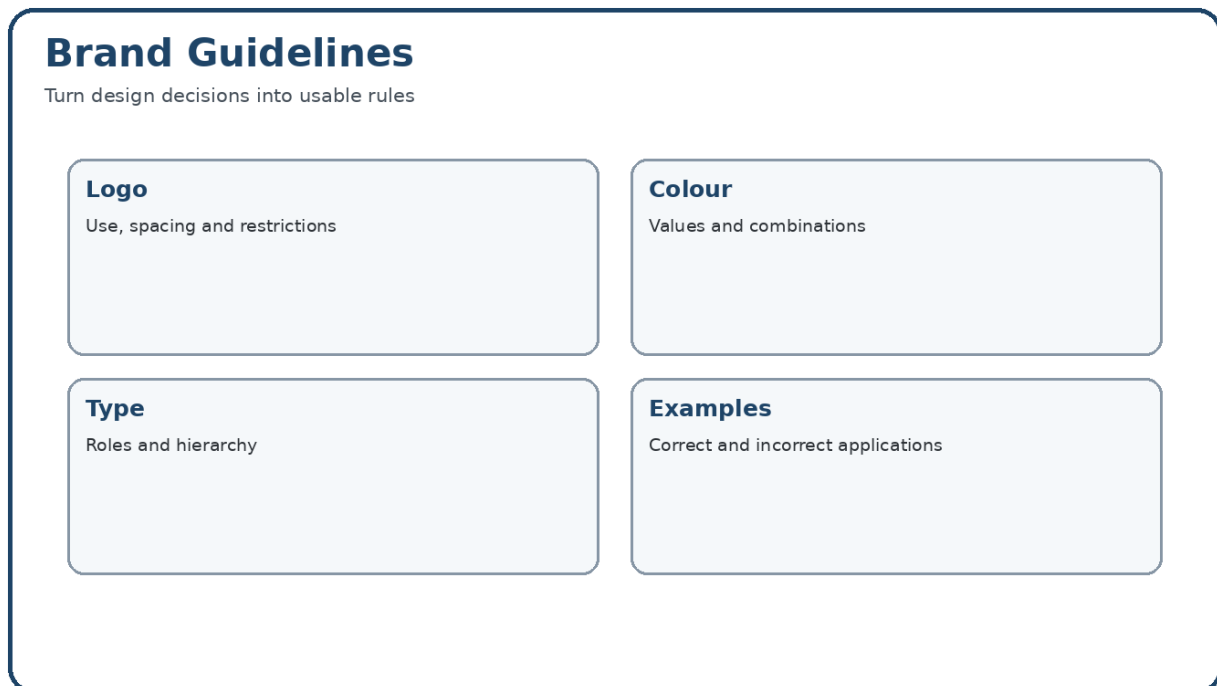


Figure 13: Original instructional visual for Brand Guidelines.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a six-page mini guideline outline.
2. Add logo rules.
3. Add colour and typography rules.
4. Add image and graphic-element rules.
5. Create two correct and two incorrect application examples.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Ethan brand guide can help instructors, marketers and designers use approved assets consistently.

Review Questions

68. What is the main purpose of brand guidelines?
69. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
70. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
71. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 13 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 14: Digital Brand Applications

Introduction

Digital touchpoints include websites, social profiles, apps, email graphics and online learning materials.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of digital brand applications.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for digital brand applications.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Identity must remain readable on small screens.

Brand principle: Profile images often need compact marks.

Brand principle: Social templates should be reusable.

Brand principle: Interface branding should support usability rather than dominate it.

Brand principle: Digital assets should be exported at suitable dimensions.

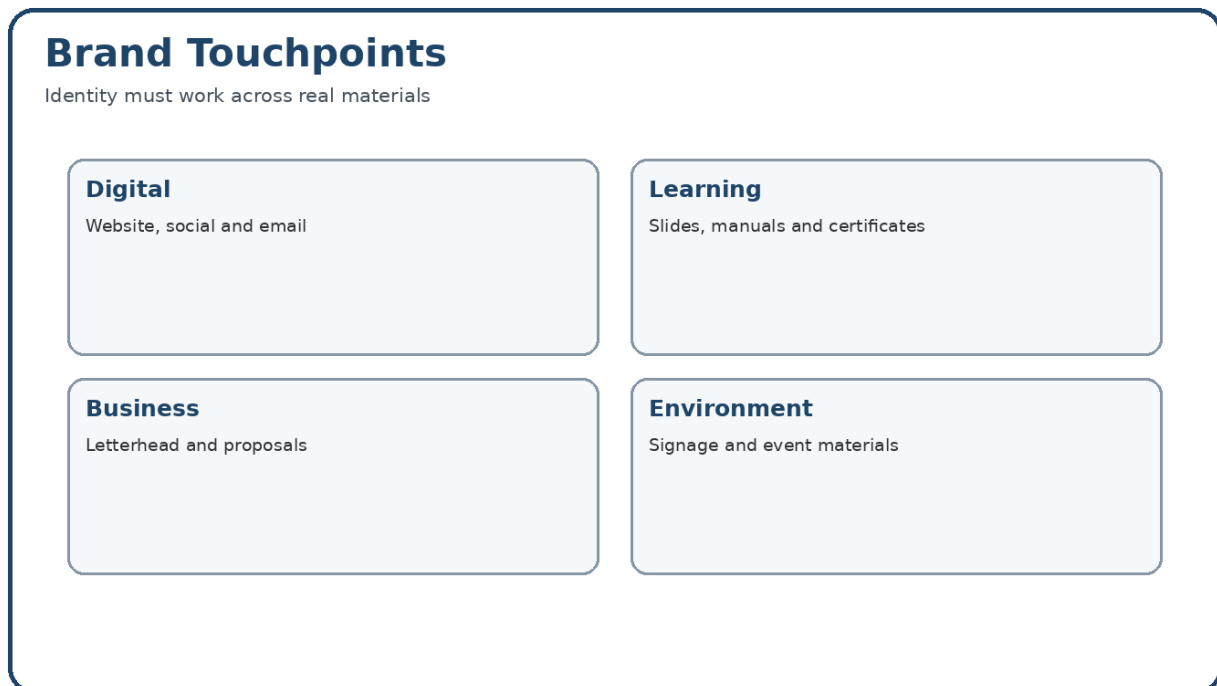


Figure 14: Original instructional visual for Digital Brand Applications.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a social profile icon.
2. Create a square course post.
3. Create a website hero concept.
4. Create a simple email-header graphic.
5. Review all four for consistency.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan's web apps and social channels can share colour, typography and logo logic while preserving each product's functional interface.

Review Questions

72. What is the main purpose of digital brand applications?
73. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
74. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
75. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 14 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 15: Print and Business Applications

Introduction

Print applications test whether the identity works on physical and formal materials.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of print and business applications.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for print and business applications.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Common applications include letterhead, certificates, business cards, folders and signage.

Brand principle: Print size and production method affect design decisions.

Brand principle: Important content needs safe margins.

Brand principle: Printer specifications should be confirmed before final production.

Brand principle: Formal documents often need more restraint than advertising graphics.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a simple letterhead concept.
2. Create a certificate header/footer concept.
3. Create a business-card or ID-card practice layout.
4. Check safe margins.
5. Prepare a print-review checklist.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan certificates and official letters should feel authoritative and consistent without becoming visually crowded.

Review Questions

76. What is the main purpose of print and business applications?
77. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
78. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
79. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 15 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 16: Brand Consistency Across Sub-Brands

Introduction

Organisations with multiple products need rules for what remains shared and what can vary.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand consistency across sub-brands.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand consistency across sub-brands.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: A master brand can lend recognition to products.

Brand principle: Endorsement can show a relationship without making every product identical.

Brand principle: Shared typography, colour logic or naming can create family resemblance.

Brand principle: Too many unrelated identities can weaken recognition.

Brand principle: Sub-brand differences should have a strategic reason.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Map a master brand and three fictional products.
2. Choose three elements that remain shared.
3. Choose one element each product may vary.
4. Create small identity tiles for the family.
5. Review whether the relationship is obvious.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Learn, Ethan AI and other Academy products can have distinct functions while visibly belonging to the Ethan Digital Academy ecosystem.

Review Questions

80. What is the main purpose of brand consistency across sub-brands?
81. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
82. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
83. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 16 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 17: Brand Audits and Refreshes

Introduction

A brand audit evaluates how consistently and effectively an existing identity is being used before deciding whether a refresh is needed.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand audits and refreshes.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand audits and refreshes.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Audit real touchpoints rather than judging only the logo.

Brand principle: Look for inconsistent colours, fonts, logo versions and messaging.

Brand principle: Separate strategic problems from execution mistakes.

Brand principle: A refresh can improve a system without discarding useful recognition.

Brand principle: Changes should be documented and rolled out carefully.

Brand Consistency Audit

Review the whole system, not just the logo

Recognition Does it look like one brand?	Readability Is information clear?
Accuracy Are details correct?	Flexibility Does it work across sizes?

Figure 17: Original instructional visual for Brand Audits and Refreshes.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Collect six fictional or instructor-provided brand touchpoints.
2. Score each for logo, colour, typography, imagery and voice consistency.
3. Identify three recurring problems.
4. Recommend corrections.
5. Decide whether the problems require a refresh or only better guidelines.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy audit may find that the core identity is strong but different apps are using inconsistent logos and typography.

Review Questions

84. What is the main purpose of brand audits and refreshes?
85. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
86. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
87. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 17 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 18: Brand Asset Management and Handoff

Introduction

A professional identity project ends with organised assets, clear naming and instructions for future users.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of brand asset management and handoff.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for brand asset management and handoff.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Keep editable masters separate from exported assets.

Brand principle: Create folders for logos, colours, fonts information, templates and guidelines.

Brand principle: Use clear version names.

Brand principle: Provide appropriate file formats for intended uses.

Brand principle: Only distribute licensed font files or third-party assets when permissions allow.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a brand-delivery folder structure.
2. Add placeholder names for primary and secondary logos.
3. Create a file-naming convention.
4. Write a short handoff note.
5. Create a checklist of assets that require licence confirmation.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Ethan identity handoff can make it easy for future designers to find the approved logo rather than using screenshots or outdated copies.

Review Questions

88. What is the main purpose of brand asset management and handoff?
89. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
90. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
91. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 18 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Lesson 19: Final Brand Identity Project

Introduction

The final project combines discovery, strategy, logo design, colour, typography, imagery, guidelines and applications into one original mini identity system.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the core principles of final brand identity project.
- Complete a guided brand-design practical for final brand identity project.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy identity scenario.

Teaching Content

Brand principle: Start with a documented brand brief and strategy.

Brand principle: Create an original flexible logo system.

Brand principle: Define colour, typography, imagery and supporting elements.

Brand principle: Create realistic digital and print applications.

Brand principle: Package the identity with guidelines and organised assets.

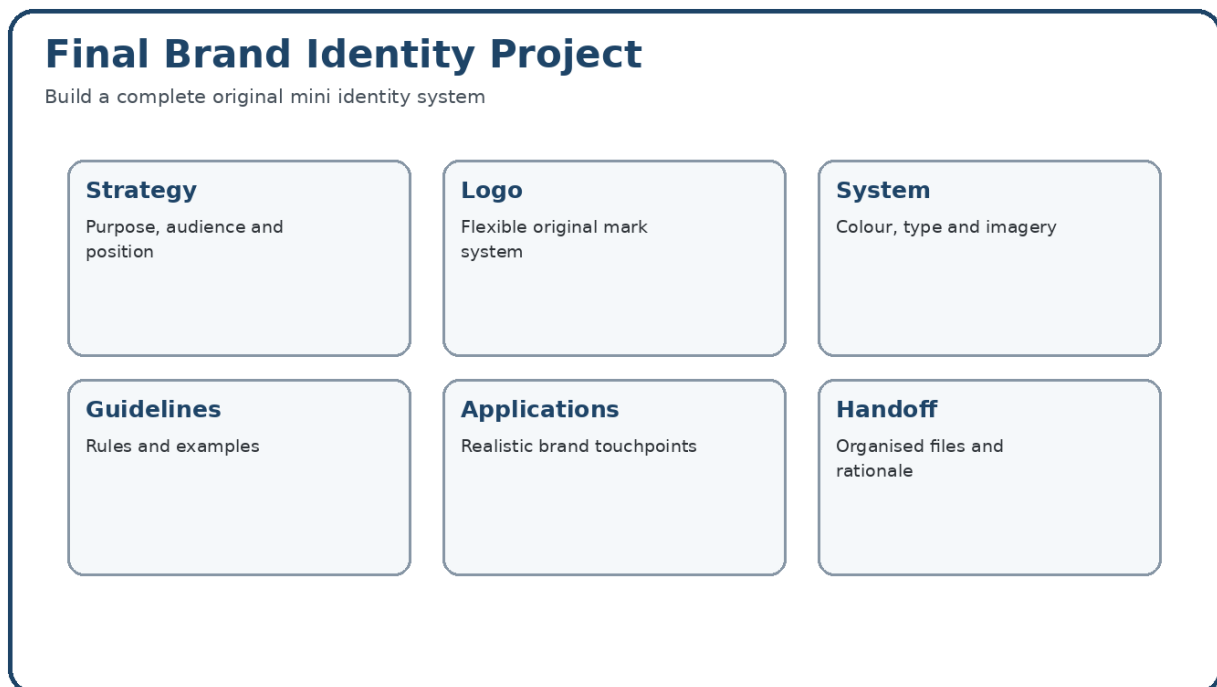


Figure 19: Original instructional visual for Final Brand Identity Project.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Write a one-page brand brief.
2. Create positioning, personality and core message.
3. Develop an original logo system.
4. Create colour and typography systems.
5. Create image and graphic-element direction.
6. Design at least four applications.
7. Create a concise brand guideline document.
8. Prepare an organised handoff package and rationale.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

The capstone demonstrates the ability to build a coherent identity system rather than a single logo.

Review Questions

92. What is the main purpose of final brand identity project?
93. State two professional brand practices from this lesson.
94. What inconsistency, copyright or strategy mistake should be avoided?
95. How would this lesson improve an Ethan Digital Academy touchpoint?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 19 practical using original or authorised content. Submit the design/strategy output plus a short rationale explaining how it supports the brand purpose, audience and consistency.

Final Brand Identity Project - 100 Marks

Component	Marks	Requirement
Discovery & strategy	15	Purpose, audience, positioning, personality and message.
Original logo system	20	Primary, alternate/compact and monochrome versions.
Colour & typography	15	Functional, readable and consistent system.
Imagery & supporting elements	10	Clear art direction and original graphic language.
Brand guidelines	15	Practical rules and correct/incorrect examples.
Applications	10	At least four coherent digital/print touchpoints.
Responsible practice	5	Original/licensed assets and accurate claims.
Handoff & rationale	10	Organised assets and explanation of decisions.

Course Quiz - 30 Questions

1. Define brand identity.
2. Why is a logo only one part of a brand identity?
3. What is brand discovery?
4. Name three subjects that discovery research should cover.
5. What is brand positioning?
6. What is a brand promise?
7. What is brand personality?
8. What is brand architecture?
9. Name three common logo forms or configurations.
10. Why should a logo work in one colour?
11. What is logo clear space?
12. What is a primary brand colour?
13. What is an accent colour?
14. Why is contrast important?
15. Name four typography roles.
16. Why should font licensing be considered?
17. What are supporting graphic elements?
18. What is image direction?
19. Why should brand images not imply events or partnerships that did not occur?
20. What is brand voice?
21. How can tone change while voice remains consistent?
22. What is a layout system?
23. What is the purpose of brand guidelines?
24. Name four sections that can appear in a brand guide.
25. Name three digital brand applications.
26. Name three print/business applications.
27. What is a sub-brand?

28. What is a brand audit?
29. Why are organised asset folders important?
30. List six major deliverables or stages in the final Brand Identity Project.

Final Examination - 100 Marks

Section A - Brand Foundations (20 marks)

Explain brand identity, discovery, strategy, positioning, personality and architecture.

Section B - Visual Identity System (20 marks)

Explain logo systems, colour, typography, supporting graphics and image direction.

Section C - Voice, Layout and Guidelines (20 marks)

Explain brand voice, messaging, layout systems and the structure of useful guidelines.

Section D - Applications and Brand Families (20 marks)

Plan digital, print and sub-brand applications for an education organisation.

Section E - Audit, Handoff and Professional Practice (20 marks)

Explain brand audits, refresh decisions, intellectual-property responsibility and organised asset handoff.

Course Completion Outcome

After successful completion, the learner should be able to research and define a brand, create an original logo family, build colour and typography systems, define image and graphic direction, establish brand voice and layout rules, document the system in practical guidelines, apply it across digital and print touchpoints, review consistency across sub-brands, conduct a basic brand audit and deliver an organised identity package.

Professional Practice Checklist

- Begin with discovery and strategy before visual execution.
- Create original identity concepts rather than imitating existing brands.
- Test logos at small size and in one colour.
- Assign clear roles to colours and typography.
- Use authorised images and accurate claims.
- Document logo, colour, type, imagery and layout rules.
- Review identity across real touchpoints.
- Keep editable masters and approved exports organised.
- Confirm trademark, domain and licensing requirements before real commercial adoption.